AIKIA.WALLET / COST PER CAFE

What one cafe costs us to serve.

Cost price only, no selling price. Every item we need to run the service and look after a cafe, per month and per year. Own Google and Apple wallet, no PassKit. Prices checked 19 October 2026 at Rs 96 to the US dollar.

Rs 7,136

A MONTH per cafe if we serve 5 cafes (year 1, including start-up costs). Rs 85,636 a year.

Rs 3,645

A MONTH per cafe at 5 cafes from year 2 (start-up costs repaid). Rs 43,736 a year.

Rs 100

A MONTH: the cafe's own direct cost (support, hosting growth, extras). The rest is its share of shared costs.

Why the number depends on how many cafes we have. Most of the cost is shared: hosting, database, Apple, accounts and travel cost the same whether we serve 1 cafe or 50. A cafe's cost is its direct cost plus its share of the shared bill. Section 3 shows it for 1 to 100 cafes.

Not included. Founders' salaries and time, office rent, paid advertising, WhatsApp or SMS messages, a penetration test (about Rs 1 to 1.5 lakh once, past 10 cafes) and the lawyer's opinion on prepaid credit (Rs 50,000 to 1 lakh, only before real-money credit).

1 / SHARED RUNNING COSTS

What we pay to run the service at all

Item	Basis	Src	A month	A year
Hosting Vercel Pro, 1 seat: app, join page, staff scanner, owner dashboard, guest pages, scheduled jobs	US$20 a month	S	Rs 1,920	Rs 23,040
Database and ledger Supabase Pro: members, ledger, credit, gifts, logins, daily backups kept 7 days	US$25 a month	S	Rs 2,400	Rs 28,800
Apple Wallet Apple Developer Program: our pass certificate and iPhone card updates	US$99 a year	S	Rs 792	Rs 9,504
Weather data Open-Meteo commercial licence for weather-mood messages	US$29 a month (confirm)	S	Rs 2,784	Rs 33,408
Code security GitHub Team, 2 users: protected code and reviews	about US$4 a user a month	S	Rs 768	Rs 9,216
GST on imported software 18% on the five services above (claimable once GST-registered)	18%	S	Rs 1,560	Rs 18,714
Accounts and GST filing Chartered accountant retainer	monthly	E	Rs 2,500	Rs 30,000
Phone and internet Business phone and data for support and sales	monthly	E	Rs 1,000	Rs 12,000
Travel Visits for onboarding, support and sales	monthly	E	Rs 3,000	Rs 36,000
Admin Printing, stationery, bank charges, small tools	monthly	E	Rs 1,000	Rs 12,000
Shared running cost			**Rs 17,724**	**Rs 2,12,682**

Needed but free at our size

Item	What it does	Cost
Google Wallet API and console	Android cards, updates, messages, nearby alerts	Rs 0
Apple push notifications	Tells iPhones to refresh the card	Rs 0
Email (Resend free tier)	Login links and alerts, up to 3,000 a month	Rs 0
Automation (GitHub Actions)	Tests, nightly backup, health checks	Rs 0
Off-site backup (Cloudflare R2)	Nightly encrypted database copy, up to 10 GB	Rs 0
DNS and protection (Cloudflare)	Domain records, DDoS shield	Rs 0
Password manager (Bitwarden, 2 users)	Keys and passwords vault	Rs 0
Domain	wallet.aikia.world sub-domain	Rs 0

2 / ONE-TIME AND DIRECT COSTS

Start-up costs and the cost of each cafe

One-time, to start the service (spread over the first 12 months)

Item	Src	Once	A month in year 1
Development left before launch Apple engine, own Google engine switch, automation, security, testing (33 days at a partner rate; Rs 0 if built in-house)	E	Rs 1,10,000	Rs 9,167
Lawyer Cafe agreement, privacy notice (DPDP Act), programme terms	E	Rs 60,000	Rs 5,000
GST registration CA set-up fee	E	Rs 5,000	Rs 417
Trademark aikia.wallet, 1 class, e-filing government fee	S	Rs 4,500	Rs 375
Test iPhone Second-hand, if no one in the team has one	E	Rs 25,000	Rs 2,083
Total		**Rs 2,04,500**	**Rs 17,042**

Each cafe, once (spread over its first 12 months)

Item	Src	Once	A month in year 1
QR standee and counter poster Printed and laminated	E	Rs 400	Rs 33
Onboarding visit Travel and time to set up the venue, tiers and staff (about 2 hours)	E	Rs 600	Rs 50

Each cafe, every month

Item	Src	A month	A year
Support Calls, changes to offers, staff questions (about 1 hour a month of time and calls)	E	Rs 60	Rs 720
Hosting growth Extra database rows, traffic and card updates for 100 to 200 customers	E	Rs 20	Rs 240
Card messages and alerts Google and Apple card updates and push (free); our alert emails	E	Rs 0	Rs 0
Replacement standee and small extras Worn posters, reprints	E	Rs 20	Rs 240
Direct cost of one cafe		**Rs 100**	**Rs 1,200**

Customers don't add cost. Google and Apple charge nothing per card, so a cafe with 100 or 200 customers costs us the same. A cafe's ledger for a year is a few MB.

3 / COST OF ONE CAFE

Per cafe, per month and per year

Year 1 (start-up costs spread over 12 months)

Cafes we serve	Share of running costs	Share of start-up costs	Direct cost	Cost of one cafe a month	A year
1	Rs 17,724	Rs 17,042	Rs 183	**Rs 34,949**	**Rs 4,19,382**
3	Rs 5,908	Rs 5,681	Rs 183	**Rs 11,772**	**Rs 1,41,261**
5	Rs 3,545	Rs 3,408	Rs 183	**Rs 7,136**	**Rs 85,636**
10	Rs 1,772	Rs 1,704	Rs 183	**Rs 3,660**	**Rs 43,918**
25	Rs 709	Rs 682	Rs 183	**Rs 1,574**	**Rs 18,887**
50	Rs 354	Rs 341	Rs 183	**Rs 879**	**Rs 10,544**
100	Rs 177	Rs 170	Rs 183	**Rs 531**	**Rs 6,372**

Year 2 onward (start-up costs repaid)

Cafes we serve	Share of running costs	Share of start-up costs	Direct cost	Cost of one cafe a month	A year
1	Rs 17,724	Rs 0	Rs 100	**Rs 17,824**	**Rs 2,13,882**
3	Rs 5,908	Rs 0	Rs 100	**Rs 6,008**	**Rs 72,094**
5	Rs 3,545	Rs 0	Rs 100	**Rs 3,645**	**Rs 43,736**
10	Rs 1,772	Rs 0	Rs 100	**Rs 1,872**	**Rs 22,468**
25	Rs 709	Rs 0	Rs 100	**Rs 809**	**Rs 9,707**
50	Rs 354	Rs 0	Rs 100	**Rs 454**	**Rs 5,454**
100	Rs 177	Rs 0	Rs 100	**Rs 277**	**Rs 3,327**

> **If we serve just one cafe**, that cafe carries everything: Rs 34,949 a month (Rs 4,19,382 a year) in year 1, and Rs 17,824 a month (Rs 2,13,882 a year) after. With 100 cafes the same service costs Rs 531 a month per cafe in year 1 and Rs 277 from year 2.

Sources and notes

- Vercel, Supabase, Apple, Open-Meteo, GitHub prices and the Rs 96 rate: AIKIA.WALLET Launch Costing (own wallet), sources listed there, checked 19 Oct 2026.
- GST on imported software is a real cost until we are GST-registered; after registration it is claimed back (about Rs 1,560 a month less).
- Estimates (E) are planning figures to be replaced with real numbers after the first 3 months.